

19 — Classes (the component system)

This chapter defines every class, superseding the old four. Each of the **48 classes** is generated from the same component vocabulary used everywhere else in the book — weapon types (17-weapons.md), armor tiers (18-armor.md), and schools of magic (10-spell-list.md). Character creation (02-character-creation.md) points here for the roster.

How classes are generated

A class is a **legal combination of components**. Pick a template, fill its slots, and you have a class — that's the whole generator. Everything below is the rules that decide which combinations are legal and balanced.

The components

- Weapon types:** Light · Medium · Heavy · Ranged
- Armor tiers:** Light · Heavy · None
- Schools of magic:** Destruction · Conjunction · Alteration · Illusion · Restoration

The legal templates

Fighting classes (*no magic*):

Template	Slots
Armored	2 weapon types + 1 armor tier (light or heavy)
Naked weapon-master	3 weapon types + no armor

Magic classes (*cast from a pool; light or no armor only — heavy blocks casting*):

Template	Slots
Half-caster	1 school + 1 weapon type + light armor
Spellsword	2 schools + 1 martial weapon (medium/heavy) + no armor
Caster	2 schools + light armor
Full caster	3 schools + no armor

The build economy (the balance spine)

- Every class is exactly 3 perks.** A pick is *1 weapon type* or *1 school*; an armor tier carries a perk too.
- Baseline = **2 picks + an armor tier** = 3 perks.
 - Going naked (no armor) buys a 3rd pick** but drops you to the lowest HP *and* Armor — the glass-cannon bargain.
 - Each component grants one **perk** (the 11 below); your class also has **1 unique override** you may swap in for any one of them (it *replaces*, never adds — so the total is always 3).
 - A class is legal **iff it lands on 3 perks** under this economy. That makes balance checkable by counting.
 - No class ever exceeds 3 perks.** So you can't have 2 schools *and* a weapon *and* armor (that's 4): a 2-school gish goes **naked** (the **Spellsword** — its weapon and spells share one stat, so being lightly built is fine), and an *armored* gish takes only **1 school** (the **Half-caster**). The armored 2-school war-mage simply doesn't exist — by design.

HP & primary ability

- HP rides the armor tier:** Heavy 10 + Might · Light 8 + Might · None 6 + Might . Per-level gain 1d6 + Might (1s/2s count as 3).
- Your class grants +1 to its primary ability.** Primary is set **by feel**: Might for medium/heavy weapons, Agility for light/ranged builds; Mind or Spirit (the **pool**) for casters. It is *not* a separate combination axis.
- Your primary powers everything.** Every weapon attack, weapon damage, and spell attack uses your one primary ability (06-attack-and-defense.md). A Mind-Battlemage's blade *and* its fire both run off Mind; a Might-Knight's everything runs off Might. One stat, whole character — which is what lets a gish wield a real weapon without splitting its ability investment.

The weight rules (what heavy gear costs)

- Heavy weapons are two-handed.** No shield, no off-hand. Medium and light are one-handed.
- No ranged weapons in heavy armor.** Heavy armor is the melee line — you cannot use bows, crossbows, or thrown weapons while wearing it. Archers and skirmishers live in light or no armor. (*This is why every heavy-armor class is a Might melee build — and why there's no tanky-archer.*)
- Set to Strike — heavy gear plants you.** On a turn where you **move and attack**:
 - wielding a **heavy weapon** *or* wearing **heavy armor** → that **attack is at disadvantage**;
 - wielding a heavy weapon *and* wearing heavy armor → you **can't do both: take your move *or* your attack this turn, not both.**

Stand your ground (use no movement) and you strike normally. (*Disadvantage is binary — 01-core-mechanic.md — so the "both heavy" case escalates to denial rather than stacking dice.*) This gives heavy gear a real cost without a speed stat: **heavy = the immovable melee anchor; light/none = mobile**. It also synergizes with the perks — heavy armor's **Bulwark** and heavy weapons reward planting; light armor's **Slip Away** rewards moving.

Spellcasting access

A magic class casts from one **pool** (level + Mind *or* level + Spirit), knows 2 cantrips + the spells-known table (09-magic.md), drawn from its accessible **schools** (10-spell-list.md). Cast freely in light or no armor; **heavy armor blocks casting** (so no magic class wears it). Casters are trained in casting (spell attack = d20 + pool + training).

The 11 component perks

Each component grants one signature perk, shared by anyone who takes it.

Weapon perks

Component	Perk	Effect
Light	Sneak Strike	Once per turn, when you attack with advantage or an ally is adjacent to your target, deal +1d6 on a hit.
Medium	Riposte	Once per round, when a creature misses you in melee, immediately make one weapon attack against it.
Heavy	Cleave	When your attack drops a creature to 0 HP, make another attack against a different target in reach, same action.
Ranged	Deadeye	Your ranged attacks ignore half-cover. Once per turn, if your target is at Far range, deal +1d6 on a hit.

Armor perks

Component	Perk	Effect
Light armor	Slip Away	When an adjacent enemy takes an action that isn't attacking you, move up to half your Speed without provoking.
Heavy armor	Bulwark	Allies adjacent to you have +1 Armor . (<i>A flat bonus to a static defense — permitted; the "no stacking +1" rule governs d20 rolls.</i>)

School perks

Component	Perk	Effect
Destruction	Devastation	Once per turn, reroll 1s and 2s on a Destruction spell's damage dice.
Conjuration	Master Summoner	Your summons get +1 to attack and last 2 extra rounds (see Summoning, 10-spell-list.md).
Alteration	Arcane Ward	While you have 1+ mana , you gain +2 Armor .
Illusion	Beguiling	Creatures roll at disadvantage to resist or break free of your Illusion effects.
Restoration	Divine Touch	As your action, touch a creature to heal 1d6 + pool . Usable 1 + pool times per rest.

The override perk

Each class ships with **one unique signature perk**, which you may **swap in for any one of your 3 component perks**. It replaces, never adds — total stays 3. It's tuned to ≈ a component perk in power (unique, not stronger), and it's the one thing only your class does. Optional: keep all 3 component perks if you prefer.

How the original four map

Old class	New class (#)	Components	Component perks
Warrior	Knight (#9)	Medium + Heavy · Heavy armor · Might	Riposte · Cleave · Bulwark
Scout	Ranger (#3)	Light + Ranged · Light armor · Agility	Sneak Strike · Deadeye · Slip Away
Mage	Mage (#34)	Conjuration + Illusion · Light armor · Mind	Master Summoner · Beguiling · Slip Away
Priest	Priest (#37)	Alteration + Restoration · Light armor · Spirit	Arcane Ward · Divine Touch · Slip Away

Building a character (revised step 2 of 02-character-creation.md)

1. Assign abilities +3 / +2 / +1 / +0 .
2. **Pick a class** → +1 to its primary, weapon/armor/school training, HP tier, mana (if any), 3 component perks + 1 override.
3. Ancestry (+1 + trait). 4. Background (+1 training). 5. Three trainings (4 if Human). 6. Defenses, equipment, spells.

The 48-class roster

⚔ Fighting — armored (2 weapons + 1 armor)

#	Class	Weapons	Primary	Armor	HP
1	Duelist	Light + Medium	Might	Light	Mid
2	Reaver	Light + Heavy	Might	Light	Mid
3	Ranger	Light + Ranged	Agility	Light	Mid
4	Berserker	Medium + Heavy	Might	Light	Mid
5	Skirmisher	Medium + Ranged	Might	Light	Mid
6	Outrider	Heavy + Ranged	Might	Light	Mid
7	Sentinel	Light + Medium	Might	Heavy	High
8	Vanguard	Light + Heavy	Might	Heavy	High
9	Knight	Medium + Heavy	Might	Heavy	High

(Heavy-armor classes carry no ranged weapon, per weight rule ②.)

⚔ Fighting — naked weapon-master (3 weapons, no armor) — HP Low

#	Class	Weapons	Primary
10	Gladiator	Light + Medium + Heavy	Might
11	Blademaster	Light + Medium + Ranged	Might
12	Marauder	Light + Heavy + Ranged	Might
13	Weaponmaster	Medium + Heavy + Ranged	Might

✨ Half-caster (1 school + light weapon + light armor) — HP Mid

#	Class	School	Pool
14	Spellblade	Destruction	Mind
15	Adept	Conjuration	Mind
16	Warden	Alteration	Spirit
17	Trickster	Illusion	Mind
18	Acolyte	Restoration	Spirit

🧙 Spellsword (2 schools + martial weapon, no armor) — HP Low

#	Class	Schools	Pool
19	Death Knight	Conjuration + Destruction	Mind
20	Battlemage	Alteration + Destruction	Mind
21	Hexblade	Destruction + Illusion	Mind
22	Paladin	Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
23	Spellforged	Alteration + Conjuration	Mind
24	Witch-blade	Conjuration + Illusion	Mind
25	Wraith Knight	Conjuration + Restoration	Spirit
26	Mindblade	Alteration + Illusion	Mind
27	Cleric-Knight	Alteration + Restoration	Spirit
28	Sword-Bard	Illusion + Restoration	Spirit

✨ Caster (2 schools + light armor) — HP Mid

#	Class	Schools	Pool
29	Warlock	Conjuration + Destruction	Mind
30	Sorcerer	Alteration + Destruction	Mind
31	Mentalist	Destruction + Illusion	Mind
32	Templar	Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
33	Artificer	Alteration + Conjuration	Mind
34	Mage	Conjuration + Illusion	Mind
35	Shaman	Conjuration + Restoration	Spirit
36	Enchanter	Alteration + Illusion	Mind
37	Priest	Alteration + Restoration	Spirit
38	Bard	Illusion + Restoration	Spirit

Full caster (3 schools, no armor) — HP Low

#	Class	Schools	Pool
39	Elementalist	Alteration + Conjuration + Destruction	Mind
40	Archmage	Conjuration + Destruction + Illusion	Mind
41	Necromancer	Conjuration + Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
42	Spellmystic	Alteration + Destruction + Illusion	Mind
43	Oracle	Alteration + Destruction + Restoration	Spirit
44	Witch	Destruction + Illusion + Restoration	Spirit
45	Mystic	Alteration + Conjuration + Illusion	Mind
46	Druid	Alteration + Conjuration + Restoration	Spirit
47	Spiritualist	Conjuration + Illusion + Restoration	Spirit
48	Seer	Alteration + Illusion + Restoration	Spirit

Class signatures — descriptions & overrides

Each class's one-line identity and its unique **override perk** (swaps in for one component perk). 🚩 = flagged for playtest.

Fighting — armored

- 1 • **Duelist** — *A nimble blade-dancer who turns a foe's commitment into an opening.* ↳ **En Garde:** mark a creature you hit in melee; while marked it has disadvantage attacking anyone but you, and you have advantage on Riposte against it.
- 2 • **Reaver** — *A savage raider who fights harder as the wounds pile up.* ↳ **Bloodlust:** while below half HP, your melee attacks deal +1d6 and you're immune to Frightened.
- 3 • **Ranger** — *A wilderness hunter who marks prey and never loses it.* ↳ **Hunter's Mark:** mark a creature (free, 1/turn); your attacks against it ignore cover and deal +1d6. Re-marks on a kill.
- 4 • **Berserker** — *A reckless warrior who trades skin for slaughter.* ↳ **Rage** (free, 1/rest, 1 min): melee attacks +1d6 and advantage on Might, but attacks against you have advantage.
- 5 • **Skirmisher** — *A mobile soldier who strikes and slips away.* ↳ **Hit and Run:** after you attack, move up to half your Speed without provoking.
- 6 • **Outrider** — *A roving heavy hitter who softens foes at range, then closes.* ↳ **Overwhelm:** when you hit with a ranged attack, your next melee attack vs. that target has advantage (and vice-versa).
- 7 • **Sentinel** — *An immovable guardian who punishes anyone who ignores them.* ↳ **Guardian's Wrath:** when an enemy in reach attacks an ally (not you), immediately make a melee attack against it.
- 8 • **Vanguard** — *The first through the breach, an armored spearhead.* ↳ **Breach:** as your action, charge your full Speed in a line and attack; on a hit, knock the target Prone. (Note: as a double-heavy build, this is its move-or-attack turn.)
- 9 • **Knight** — *A disciplined heavy fighter, the wall the line forms around. (the old Warrior)* ↳ **Second Wind:** once per rest, as part of any action, regain 1d6 + level HP.

Fighting — naked weapon-master

- 10 • **Gladiator** — *A crowd-pleasing arena fighter who feeds on the kill.* ↳ **Adrenaline:** each time you drop a creature to 0 HP, your next attack this round deals +1d6.
- 11 • **Blademaster** — *A peerless weapon artist who answers steel with steel.* ↳ **Deflect:** once per round, when hit, reduce the damage by 1d8 + primary .
- 12 • **Marauder** — *A brutal pillager who finishes the wounded without mercy.* ↳ **Pillage:** your attacks against creatures below half HP deal +1d8.
- 13 • **Weaponmaster** — *A master of every armament — devastating, but exposed.* ↳ **Stance:** at the start of your turn, choose +1d6 damage or +2 Armor until your next turn.

Half-caster

- 14 • **Spellblade** — *A warrior-mage who sheathes fire in steel.* ↳ **Spellstrike:** on a weapon hit, spend 1 mana to add 1d8 Destruction damage (your element).
- 15 • **Adept** — *A novice summoner backed by a conjured ally.* ↳ **Bonded Blade** (1/rest, no mana): conjure a spectral weapon that fights on your turn for the encounter (your spell attack, 1d8).
- 16 • **Warden** — *A protector who hardens flesh against harm.* ↳ **Stoneflesh:** as your action, grant yourself or a touched ally +3 Armor (ongoing, 1 min).
- 17 • **Trickster** — *A deceiver who strikes from a fold in perception.* ↳ **Vanishing Act:** once per round after you attack, briefly vanish — attacks against you have disadvantage and your next attack has advantage.
- 18 • **Acolyte** — *A field medic who mends as they fight.* ↳ **Battle Prayer:** once per rest, every ally in Near regains 1d6 + pool HP.

Spellsword (naked, 2 schools + a martial weapon)

- 19 • **Death Knight** — *A grim warrior wreathed in necrotic power and raised servants.* ↳ **Soul Reap:** when you drop a creature with a weapon attack, regain 1d6 mana (max your pool).
- 20 • **Battlemage** — *An armored-in-magic blaster who fights in the thick of it.* ↳ **Runic Weapon:** your weapon attacks deal +1d6 of a chosen element (fire/frost/shock). An at-will rider — no extra action.
- 21 • **Hexblade** — *A cursed blade that unmakes mind and body together.* ↳ **Hex:** mark a creature (free, 1/turn); your spells and attacks vs. it deal +1d6 and it has disadvantage on its first attack each round.
- 22 • **Paladin** — *A holy warrior of smiting wrath and mending light.* ↳ **Divine Smite:** on a weapon hit, spend 1–3 mana to deal 1d8 radiant per mana.
- 23 • **Spellforged** — *An artificer-warrior clad in conjured arms and wards.* ↳ **Arsenal** (1/rest): conjure a bound weapon (1d10 , your spell attack) and +2 Armor for the encounter.
- 24 • **Witch-blade** — *A fey-touched duelist flanked by phantasms.* ↳ **Phantom Double** (1/rest): an illusory twin grants you disadvantage-to-be-hit until first struck, and once grants you advantage.
- 25 • **Wraith Knight** — *A deathless sentinel who siphons life to endure.* ↳ **Lifedrain:** on a weapon hit, spend 1 mana to heal yourself 1d6 .
- 26 • **Mindblade** — *A psionic warrior whose blade is an extension of will.* ↳ **Psychic Lash:** once per turn, your weapon attack targets **Mind** (psychic); on a hit the target has disadvantage on its next attack.
- 27 • **Cleric-Knight** — *A consecrated guardian who shields and heals in armor of faith.* ↳ **Aegis:** once per round, when an ally in Near is hit, reduce that damage by 1d6 + pool .
- 28 • **Sword-Bard** — *A blade-singer who bolsters allies and beguiles foes.* ↳ **Battle Hymn:** as your action, allies in Near get advantage and enemies in Near disadvantage on their next attack.

Caster

- 29 • **Warlock** — *A pact-caster who hurls eldritch fire and calls servitors.* ↳ **Eldritch Blast:** signature cantrip — 1d10 force at Far, 0 mana; 1d12 while you have no mana left.
- 30 • **Sorcerer** — *A wild innate caster who bends and amplifies their magic.* ↳ **Overcharge:** once per turn, spend 1 extra mana on a damage spell to maximize one of its dice.
- 31 • **Mentalist** — *A mind-burning caster who shatters thought and body.* ↳ **Mind Spike** (1/rest): a creature in Near rolls Mind vs. your spell attack or is Stunned 1 round + takes 2d6 psychic.
- 32 • **Templar** — *A militant healer who scourges foes and saves allies.* ↳ **Radiant Surge:** when you cast a Destruction spell, heal an ally in Near 1d6 .
- 33 • **Artificer** — *A maker who conjures tools, turrets, and constructs.* ↳ **Turret** (1/rest): conjure a construct (acts on your turn, ranged 1d8 , 13 HP) for the encounter.
- 34 • **Mage** — *The classic arcanist: summons, glamours, and clever control. (the old Mage)* ↳ **Arcane Recovery:** once per rest, regain 1d4 + level mana.
- 35 • **Shaman** — *A spirit-speaker who calls ancestral aid and mends the tribe.* ↳ **Ancestral Spirit** (1/rest): summon a guardian (acts on your turn, melee 1d8 , or heals an adjacent ally 1d6).
- 36 • **Enchanter** — *A subtle manipulator of minds and matter.* ↳ **Dominate** (1/rest): a creature you've Charmed obeys one command — move + one action — on its turn.
- 37 • **Priest** — *A devoted healer and warder of the faithful. (the old Priest)* ↳ **Intercession:** once per rest, when an ally in Near would drop to 0 HP, they drop to 1 instead and you heal them 1d6 + pool .

- **38 • Bard** — *A charismatic performer who inspires allies and bewitches foes.* ↳ **Inspiration** (free, 1+pool/rest): give an ally advantage on their next roll of any kind.

Full caster

- **39 • Elementalist** — *A master of raw elements — fire, frost, and stone.* ↳ **Attunement:** each turn choose fire (+1d6), frost (halve target Speed), or stone (+2 Armor to you) on your Destruction spells.
- **40 • Archmage** — *The pinnacle arcanist — devastating and endlessly versatile.* ↳ **Spell Mastery:** choose one Lesser spell you know; once per rest, cast it without paying mana.
- **41 • Necromancer** — *A death-mage who raises the fallen and drains the living.* ↳ **Raise Dead** (1/rest): raise a slain creature in Near as a thrall (acts on your turn, 1d8) for the encounter.
- **42 • Spellmystic** — *A reality-warper blending force, fire, and falsehood.* ↳ **Warp:** once per round, as a free action, teleport up to Near range.
- **43 • Oracle** — *A seer channeling divine foresight, wrath, and healing.* ↳ **Foresight:** once per round, force any creature in sight to reroll a d20; you pick which result stands.
- **44 • Witch** — *A hedge-sorceress of curses, hexes, and old remedies.* ↳ **Curse:** mark a creature (free, 1/turn); it has disadvantage on defenses vs. your spells, which deal +1d6 against it.

- **45 • Mystic** — *An enigmatic caster of wards, phantoms, and bound spirits.* ↳ **Astral Step** (1/rest): become incorporeal until your next turn — move through anything, can't be grappled, attacks vs. you have disadvantage.
- **46 • Druid** — *A keeper of the wilds who shapes nature and calls beasts.* ↳ **Wild Shape** (1/rest): become a beast (GM's equivalent pick) up to 10 min; revert at your HP when it drops. 🍌
- **47 • Spiritualist** — *A medium who walks with spirits and mends through them.* ↳ **Possession** (1/rest): a willing ally in Near immediately takes a full extra turn, guided by a spirit. 🍌
- **48 • Seer** — *A prophet who sees the strands of fate and reweaves them.* ↳ **Ward of Fate:** once per round, when an ally in Near is hit, you may cause the attack to miss instead.

What this system doesn't have

- Subclasses or multiclassing (the combinations replace both).
- A separate martial resource pool (at-will weapons are the martial engine).
- A speed stat for armor (weight rule ③ handles it via tempo, not Speed).
- Per-class bespoke rules beyond 3 perks + 1 override.
- More than 3 perks on any character, ever (the balance invariant).